

Chapter 3: Environmental and Social Determinants of Cognitive Health in Puente Piedra, Peru

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- 0.1 Download Historical Purple Air Data via Data Download Tool
- 0.2 Visualizations: Processed Exposure Time Series
- 0.3 Adding location of sensor
- 0.4 Socio-demographic Data
- 0.5 Primary variables of interest
- 0.6 Using the google map data
- 0.7 Spatial Join for All Variables
- 0.8 Explore which sensors were used, how many participants were assigned to it
- 1 Load Data
 - 1.1 Examine contextual variables – clean
 - 1.2 Check missingness
 - 1.3 Create standardized versions of PM 2.5, PM 10, temperature, and humidity
 - 1.4 Descriptive Exploration
- 2 pm 10
 - 2.1 Analysis (Thursday, April 9)
 - 2.2 Primary analysis: full sample
 - 2.3 Secondary analysis: older adults (60+)
 - 2.4 Secondary analysis: younger adults (30-59):
 - 2.5 Create the age groups:
 - 2.6 Prep
 - 2.7 Model 1
 - 2.8 Model 2
 - 2.9 Model 3
 - 2.10 Combine
 - 2.11 Sensor zone comparison table to show descriptively whether zones with higher PM2.5 tend to have worse cognitive scores
 - 2.12 Highways
 - 2.13 Regression Models adjusted for age and sex
 - 2.14 Figure
 - 2.15 The *storyline* for the chapter:

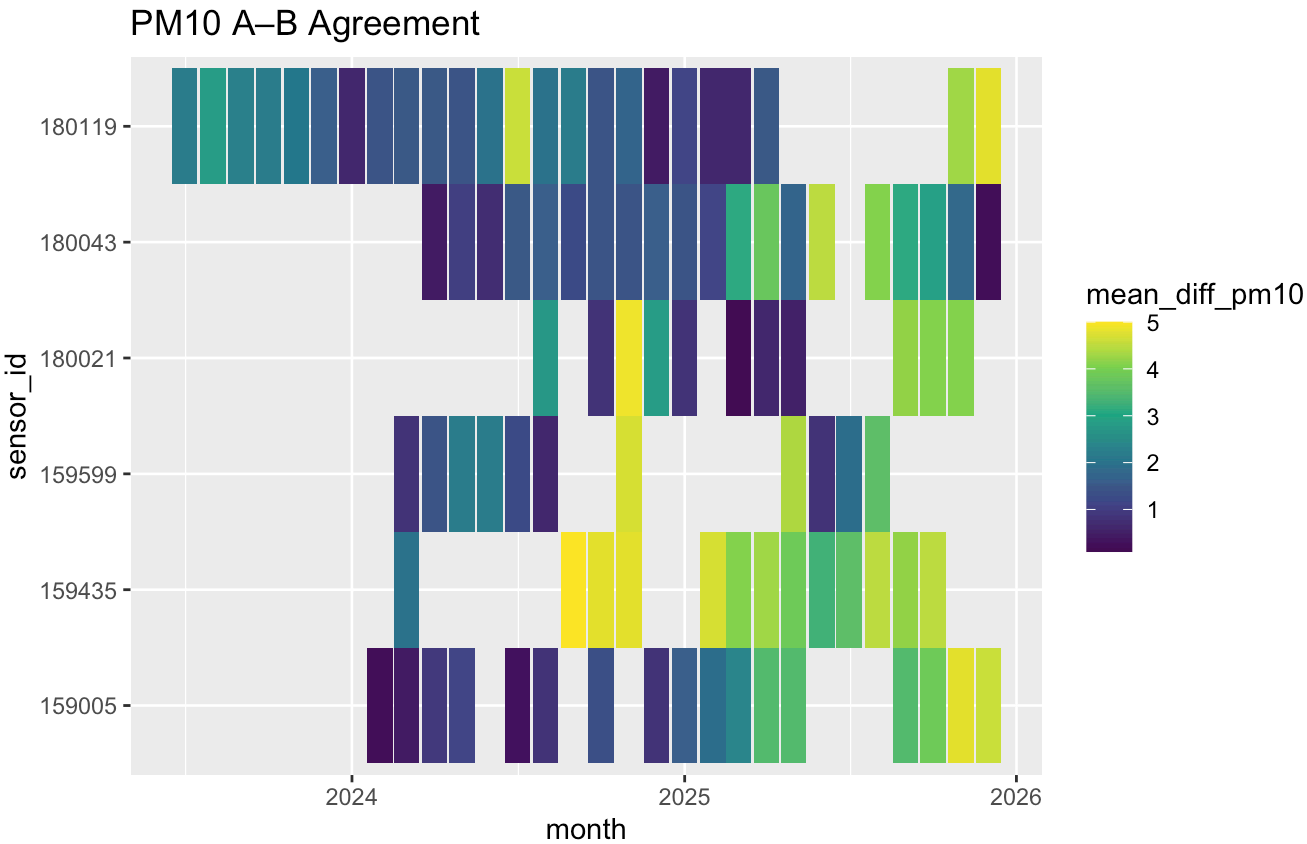
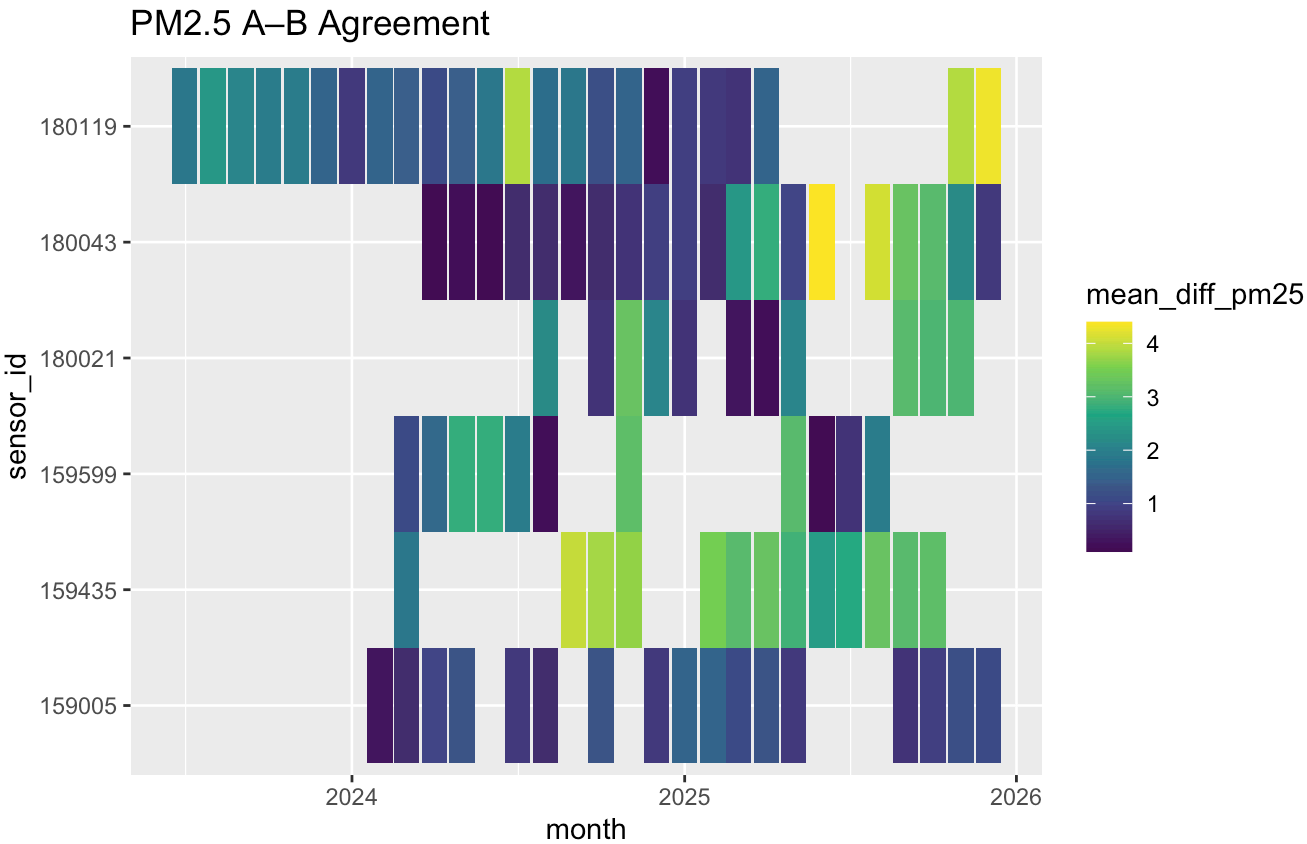
0.1 Download Historical Purple Air Data via Data Download Tool

Sensor history: <https://api.purpleair.com/#api-sensors-get-sensor-history> (<https://api.purpleair.com/#api-sensors-get-sensor-history>)

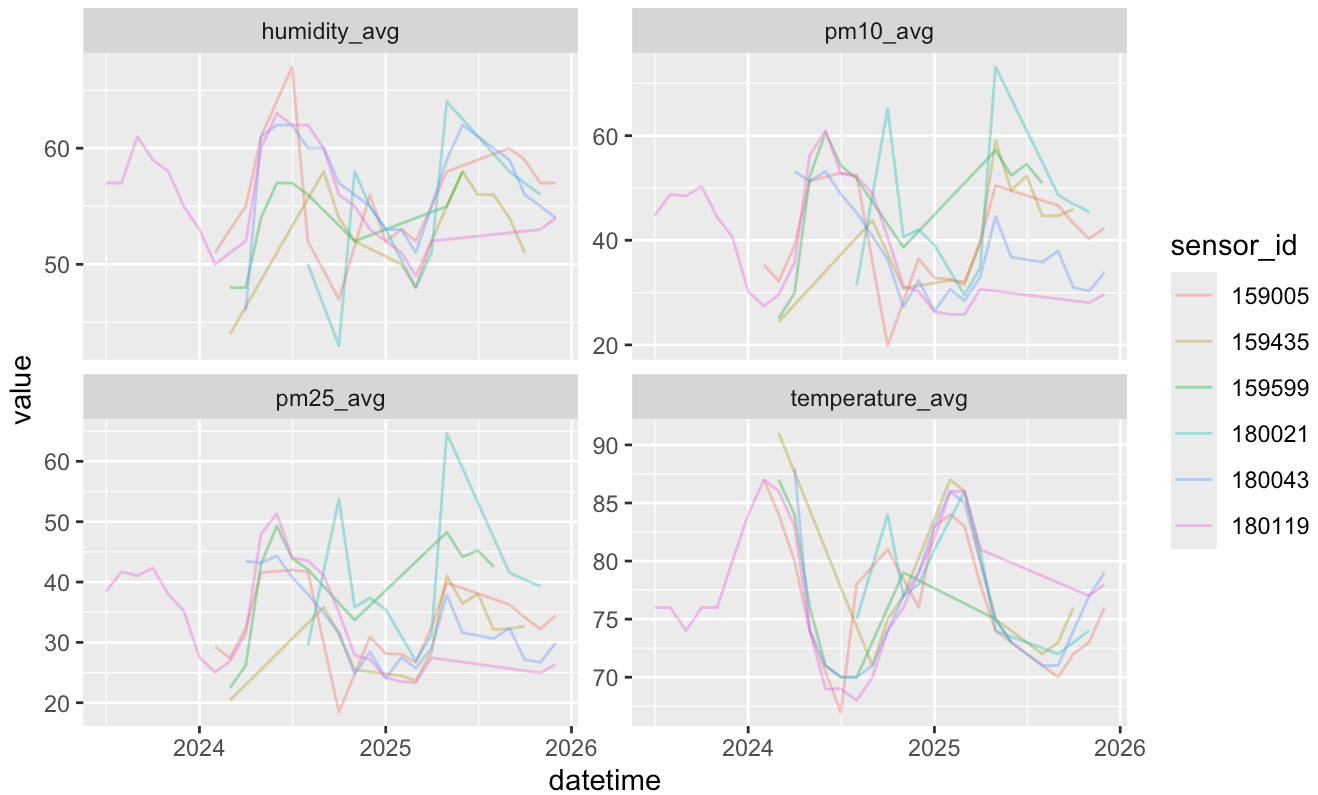
Fields: pm10.0_atm_a,pm10.0_atm_b,pm10.0_atm,voc_a,voc_b,voc,humidity,humidity_a,humidity_b,temperature,temperature_a,temperature_b,pm2.5_atm_a,pm2.5_atm_b,pm2.5_atm

Date range: 22-01-01 to 26-01-10

1-month average

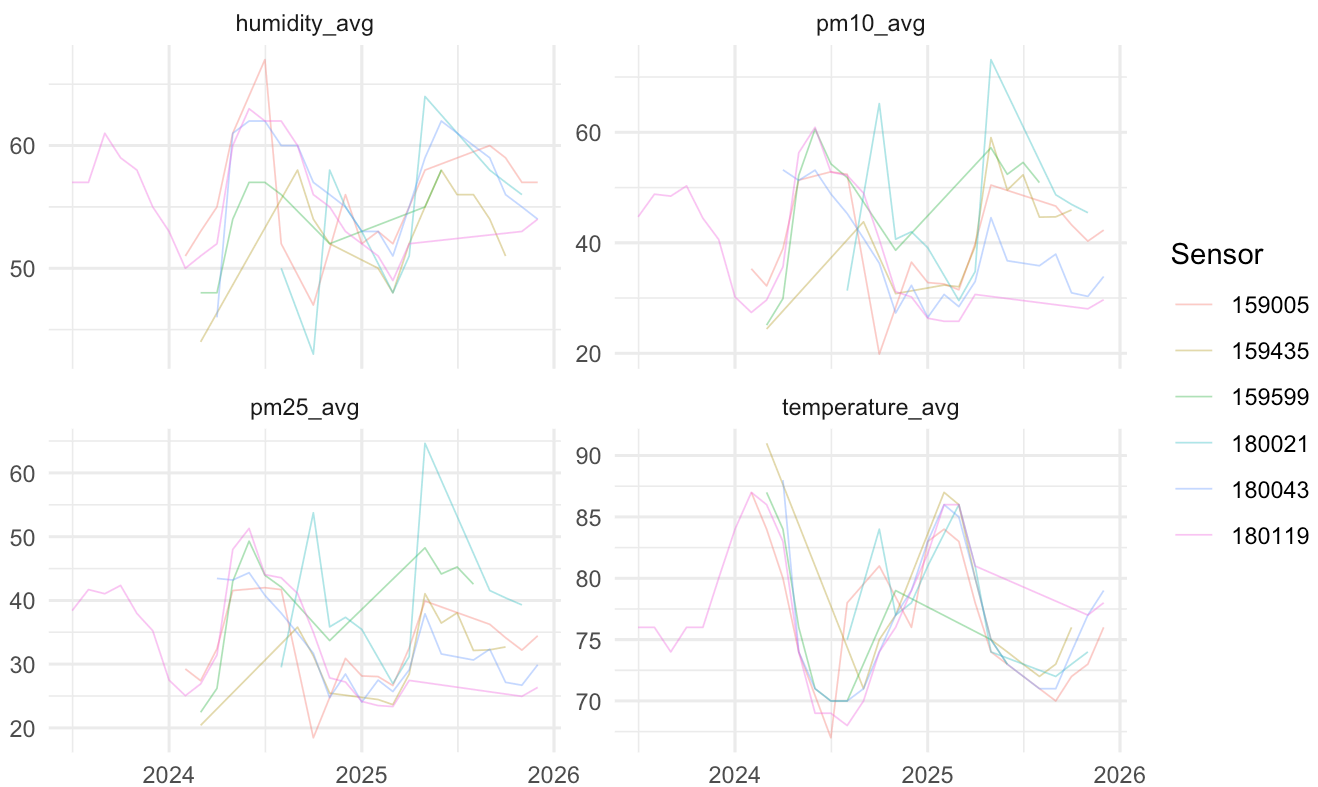


Processed PurpleAir Time Series

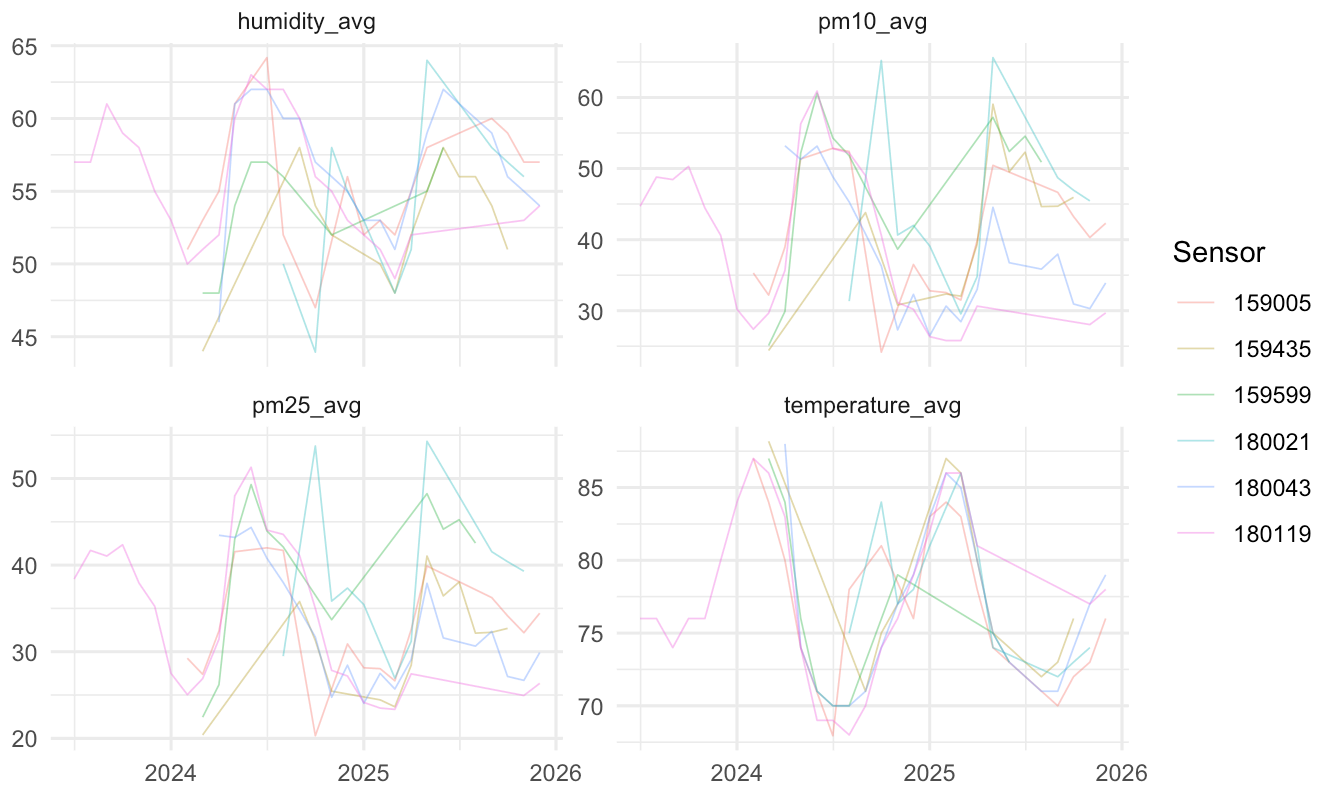


0.2 Visualizations: Processed Exposure Time Series

PurpleAir Time Series (Post-QC Exposure Variables)



Capped Time Series (1st–99th percentile) — Exposure Variables



```
## # A tibble: 4 × 9
##   variable          n mean  sd median  p25  p75  min  max
##   <chr>          <int> <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 Humidity (%)           6  54.8  1.46   54.7  53.8  55.6  52.9  56.8
## 2 PM10 (µg/m³)           6  41.9  3.89   40.6  39.4  44.2  37.9  48.0
## 3 PM2.5 (µg/m³)          6  35.0  3.89   33.3  32.6  38.2  30.9  40.1
## 4 Temperature (°F)        6  77.2  0.889  77.7  76.7  77.7  75.7  77.8
```

0.3 Adding location of sensor

Unable to get this via the data download tool, need to use the API directly

```
##
## FALSE
## 6
```

```
## # A tibble: 6 × 11
##   sensor_id mean_pm25 mean_pm10 mean_humidity mean_temperature abs_thresh
##   <fct>         <dbl>    <dbl>         <dbl>         <dbl>         <dbl>
## 1 159005         32.7      39.9         55.6         77.6           5
## 2 159435         30.9      41.3         52.9         77.7           5
## 3 159599         40.1      48.0         53.8         75.7           5
## 4 180021         39.6      45.2         53.9         77.7           5
## 5 180043         32.6      37.9         56.8         76.4           5
## 6 180119         34.0      39.2         55.6         77.8           5
## # i 5 more variables: rel_thresh <dbl>, sensor_id_clean <dbl>,
## #   sensor_name <chr>, latitude <dbl>, longitude <dbl>
```

```
## Deleting source `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/purpleair__all_sens
ors.gpkg' using driver `GPKG'
## Writing layer `purpleair__all_sensors' to data source
##   `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/purpleair__all_sensors.gpkg' usin
g driver `GPKG'
## Writing 6 features with 2 fields and geometry type Point.
```

0.4 Socio-demographic Data

New map, numbered by section. Final version of the map (<https://www.google.com/maps/d/edit?mid=1ZxIT6hY4dc9rtQl3oUCLNVQoDkfRK5w&usp=sharing>) includes sector 5.

Confirmed (as of March 25th, 2026) working dataset: “Base de datos (Monica)_09.16.2024_MN edits 09.19.2024 copy 3.xlsx”

0.5 Primary variables of interest

Cognitive scores: - ACE - RUADS - PFAQ - Dementia - Dementia AM - Dementia AJ - Dementia AJ ALT - deterioro cognitivo

Exposure-related: - pollution (pm2.5, pm10) - temperature - humidity

Geography: (account for clustering) - Distrito - Sector - Conglomerado/pin

Core standard confounders: - age - sex - education - occupation

Health-related: - bmi - glucose_lev - hypertension

Socioeconomic: - overcrowding - health_insurance - civil_stat

0.6 Using the google map data

Only 4 unmatched out of 1,099 rows.. negligible. Will proceed with the join. Those 4 participants simply won't have coordinates and will be dropped from the spatial analysis.

Many-to-many warning – makes sense, as it is expected that multiple survey participants will live in the same conglomerate (same pin/location point), so one KML point matches many survey rows. Expected for cluster-based sampling.

```
## Driver: KML
## Available layers:
##   layer_name geometry_type features fields crs_name
## 1   Sector 3      3D Point      264      2   WGS 84
## 2   Sector 1      3D Point      198      2   WGS 84
## 3   Sector 4      3D Point      200      2   WGS 84
## 4   Sector 2      3D Point      185      2   WGS 84
## 5   Sector 5      3D Point      259      2   WGS 84
```

```
## [1] 1106
```

```
## [1] "Name"      "Description" "geometry"
```

```
## Simple feature collection with 6 features and 2 fields
## Geometry type: POINT
## Dimension:      XYZ
## Bounding box:   xmin: -77.09736 ymin: -11.8496 xmax: -77.0945 ymax: -11.84723
## z_range:        zmin: 0 zmax: 0
## Geodetic CRS:   WGS 84
##   Name Description                      geometry
## 1   407             POINT Z (-77.09736 -11.8472...
## 2   409             POINT Z (-77.09628 -11.8477...
## 3   415             POINT Z (-77.09686 -11.8482 0)
## 4   417             POINT Z (-77.09519 -11.8496 0)
## 5   418             POINT Z (-77.09572 -11.8490...
## 6   420             POINT Z (-77.0945 -11.84954 0)
```

```
##
## FALSE TRUE
##      4 1095
```

```
##
## Sector 1 Sector 3
##      1      3
```

```
## [1] 1989
```

```
## Deleting source `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/spatial_survey_data.gpkg' using driver `GPKG'
## Writing layer `spatial_survey_data' to data source
##   `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/spatial_survey_data.gpkg' using driver `GPKG'
## Writing 1989 features with 25 fields and geometry type 3D Point.
```

0.7 Spatial Join for All Variables

```
## Simple feature collection with 6 features and 6 fields
## Geometry type: POINT
## Dimension:      XYZ
## Bounding box:   xmin: 271508.3 ymin: 8689420 xmax: 271626.9 ymax: 8689480
## z_range:        zmin: 0 zmax: 0
## Projected CRS: WGS 84 / UTM zone 18S
##   conglomerado_chr      nearest_sensor_name exposure_pm25 exposure_pm10
## 1                407 GE0Health_MiPeru_Chavinillo      32.70588      39.94412
## 2                407 GE0Health_MiPeru_Chavinillo      32.70588      39.94412
## 3                409 GE0Health_MiPeru_Chavinillo      32.70588      39.94412
## 4                409 GE0Health_MiPeru_Chavinillo      32.70588      39.94412
## 5                409 GE0Health_MiPeru_Chavinillo      32.70588      39.94412
## 6                409 GE0Health_MiPeru_Chavinillo      32.70588      39.94412
##   exposure_temp exposure_humidity      geometry
## 1      77.64706      55.58824 POINT Z (271508.3 8689480 0)
## 2      77.64706      55.58824 POINT Z (271508.3 8689480 0)
## 3      77.64706      55.58824 POINT Z (271626.9 8689420 0)
## 4      77.64706      55.58824 POINT Z (271626.9 8689420 0)
## 5      77.64706      55.58824 POINT Z (271626.9 8689420 0)
## 6      77.64706      55.58824 POINT Z (271626.9 8689420 0)
```

```
## Deleting source `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/spatial_data_final.
gpkg' using driver `GPKG'
## Writing layer `spatial_data_final' to data source
##   `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/spatial_data_final.gpkg' using dr
iver `GPKG'
## Writing 1989 features with 31 fields and geometry type 3D Point.
```

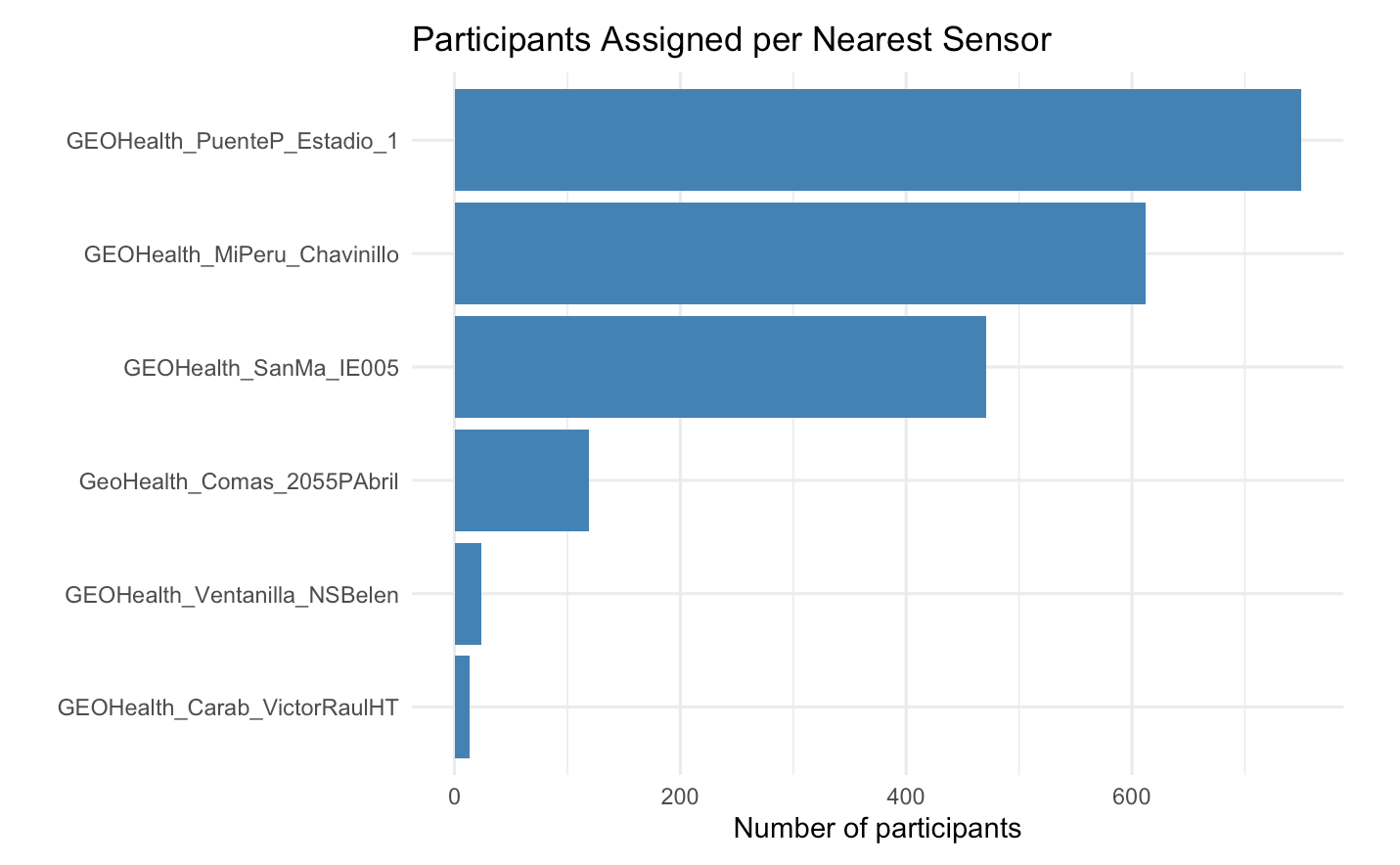
0.8 Explore which sensors were used, how many participants were assigned to it

A few things to note: - 180119 and 159005 cover the bulk of participants (750 and 612) — results will be heavily influenced by these two sensors - 159435 and 180021 have very few participants assigned (24 and 13) — these are likely on the geographic periphery of the study area

Limitations: exposure assignment was constrained to 6 sensors, with the majority of participants assigned to just 2 sensors — which reduces spatial variability in exposure estimates.

1 Load Data

##	nearest_sensor_id	nearest_sensor_name	n
## 1	180119	GEOHealth_PuenteP_Estadio_1	750
## 2	159005	GEOHealth_MiPeru_Chavinillo	612
## 3	180043	GEOHealth_SanMa_IE005	471
## 4	159599	GeoHealth_Comas_2055PAbril	119
## 5	159435	GEOHealth_Ventanilla_NSBelen	24
## 6	180021	GEOHealth_Carab_VictorRaulHT	13



1.1 Examine contextual variables – clean

```
##      Var1 Freq
## 1      0   97
## 2      1   31
## 3     10   54
## 4     11  549
## 5     12  101
## 6     13   77
## 7     14  149
## 8    14.5    1
## 9     15   30
## 10    16   79
## 11    17    6
## 12    18    9
## 13    19   10
## 14     2   40
## 15    20    2
## 16    23    1
## 17     3   60
## 18     4   44
## 19     5   86
## 20     6  290
## 21     7   39
## 22     8   52
## 23     9  110
## 24 <NA>   72
```

```
##
##              0    1
## none              57  29
## primary           391 135
## secondary_or_higher 1136 115
```

```
##      civil_stat  n
## 1  Conviviente 645
## 2   Casado(a) 552
## 3   Soltero(a) 408
## 4  Separado(a) 141
## 5    Viudo(a) 138
## 6         <NA>  73
## 7 Divorciado(a) 32
```

```
##      occupation  n
## 1   Amo(a) de casa 634
## 2   Auto-empleado(a) 446
## 3   Sin empleo actual 327
## 4   Empleado(a) 297
## 5   Jubilado(a) 114
## 6   Freelance 94
## 7   <NA> 75
## 8   Estudiante 2
```

```
##
##      partnered      single separated_widowed      <NA>
##      1197      408      311      73
```

```
##
##      employed      homemaker not_employed      <NA>
##      837      634      443      75
```

```

##
## --- education_cat ---
##
##           0    1
##   none           57   29
##   primary        387  135
##   secondary_or_higher 1134 112
##
## --- civil_stat_cat ---
##
##           0    1
##   partnered      979 182
##   single         334  58
##   separated_widowed 265  36
##
## --- occupation_cat ---
##
##           0    1
##   employed      715 101
##   homemaker     482 124
##   not_employed  381  51
##
## --- htn ---
##
##           0    1
##   HTA diastólica      87   19
##   HTA sistodiastólica 185   33
##   HTA sistólica      154   10
##   Sin hipertensión    1152 214
##
## --- native_lang ---
##
##           0    1
##   Castellano      1306 176
##   Quechua o aimara 272  100
##
## --- health_ins ---
##
##           0    1
##   Entidad prestadora de salud    11   1
##   Essalud                       349  32
##   Fuerzas armadas o policiales    46   0
##   No está afiliado                217  45
##   No sabe                         35  22
##   Seguro integral de salud (SIS) 888 175
##   Seguro privado de salud         32   1
##
## --- chronic_dis ---
##
##           0    1
##   No 982 190
##   Sí 596  86

```

```
##
## ---- sex ----
##
##           0    1
## Femenino 1067 242
## Masculino  511  34
```

```
##
##           0    1
## SIS      890 178
## Essalud  350  32
## uninsured 220  45
## other    124  24
```

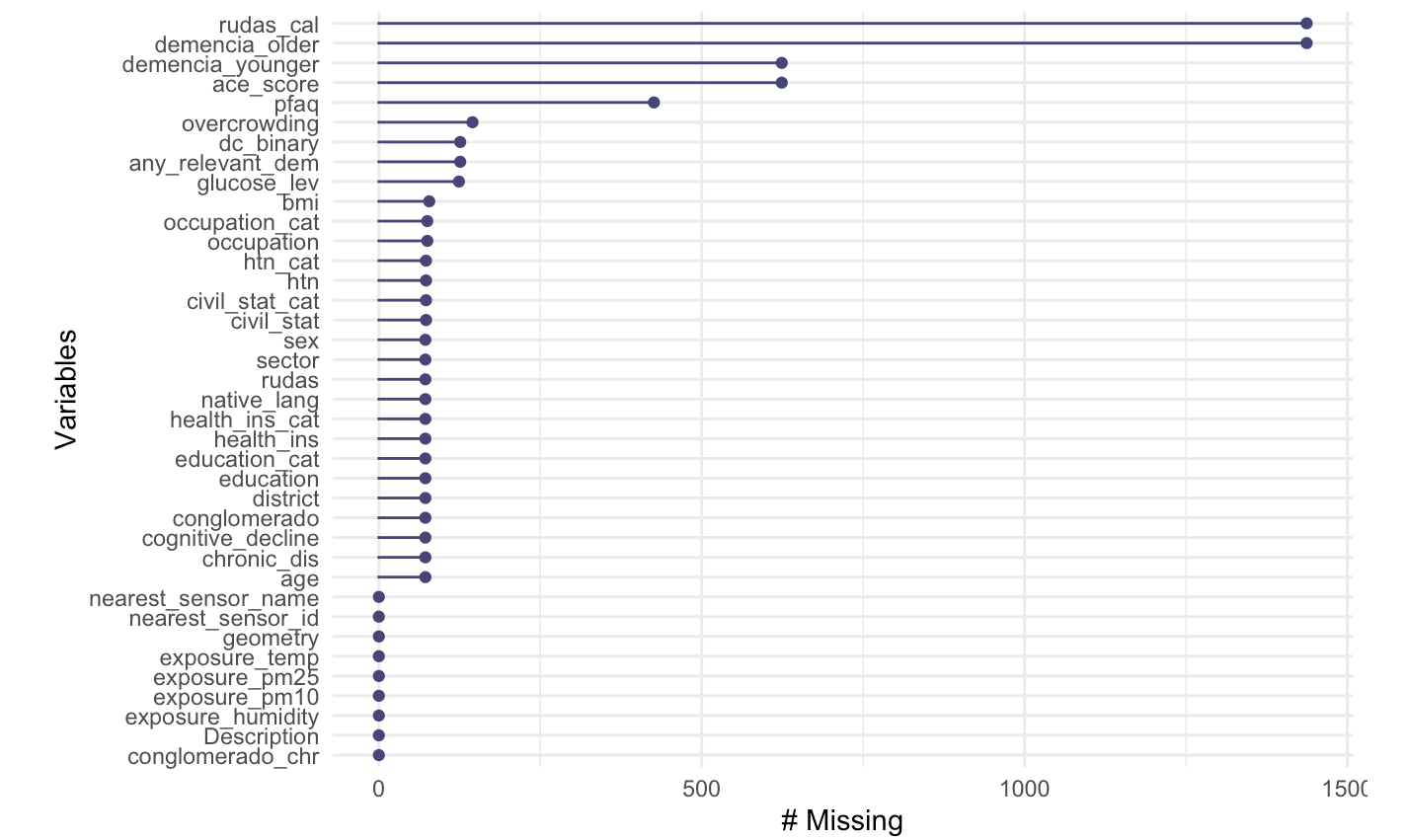
```
##
##           0    1
## HTA diastólica      87  19
## HTA sistodiastólica 185  33
## HTA sistólica      154  10
## Sin hipertensión   1152 214
```

```
##
##           0    1
## none      1154 217
## hypertension 429  62
```

```
## [1] "numeric"
```

```
##   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.   NA's
##  15.82   25.51   28.32   28.85   31.42   51.85    78
```

1.2 Check missingness



```
##
##      0      1
## 1584  279
```

```
## [1] 1854
```

```
## exposure_pm25  n
## 1      30.93462 24
## 2      32.60750 471
## 3      32.70588 612
## 4      33.97500 750
## 5      39.63182  13
## 6      40.08182 119
```

1.3 Create standardized versions of PM 2.5, PM 10, temperature, and humidity

and quartile for PM 2.5

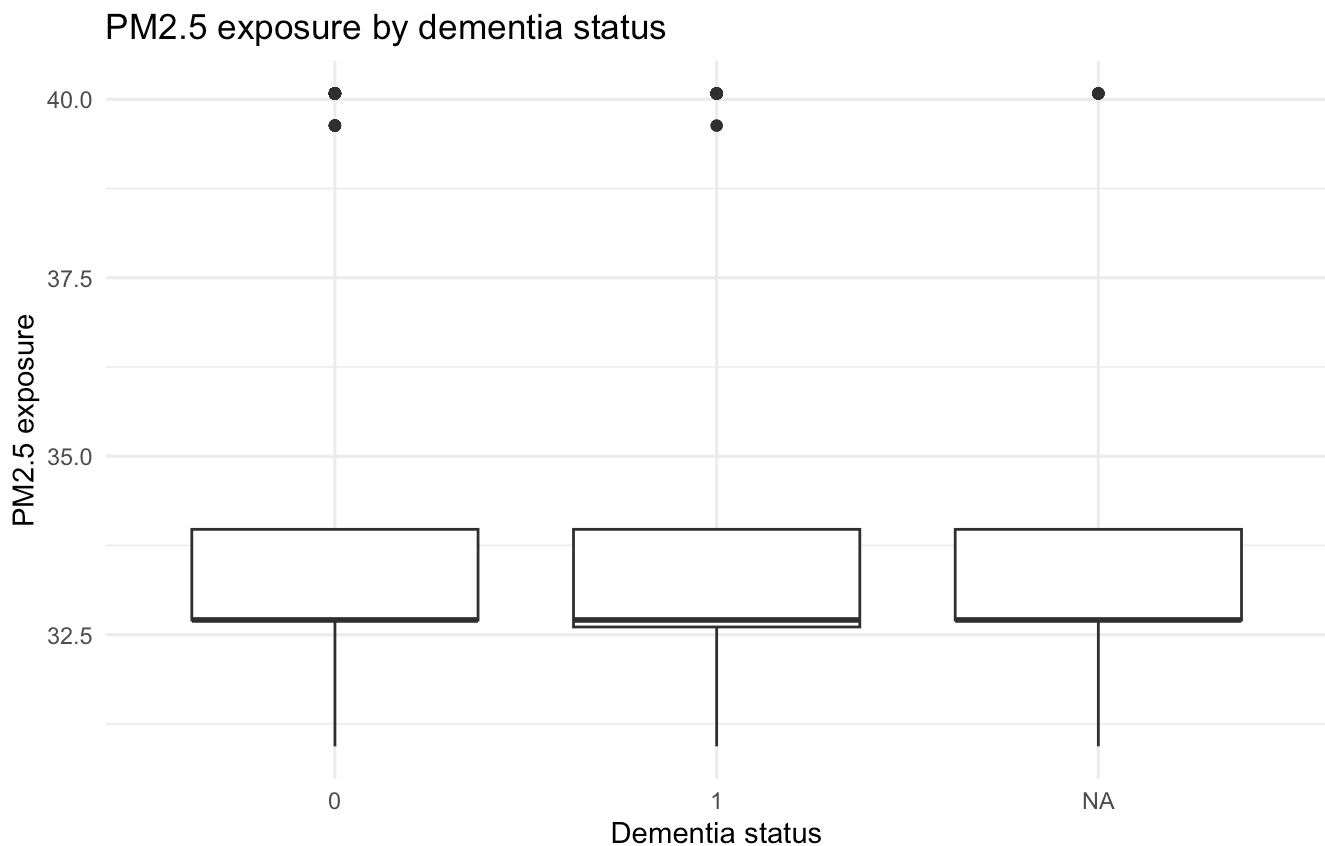
Interpretation: SD models: OR = dementia odds per 1 SD increase in exposure Quartile models: OR = dementia odds relative to lowest exposure group

```
## [1] "numeric"
```

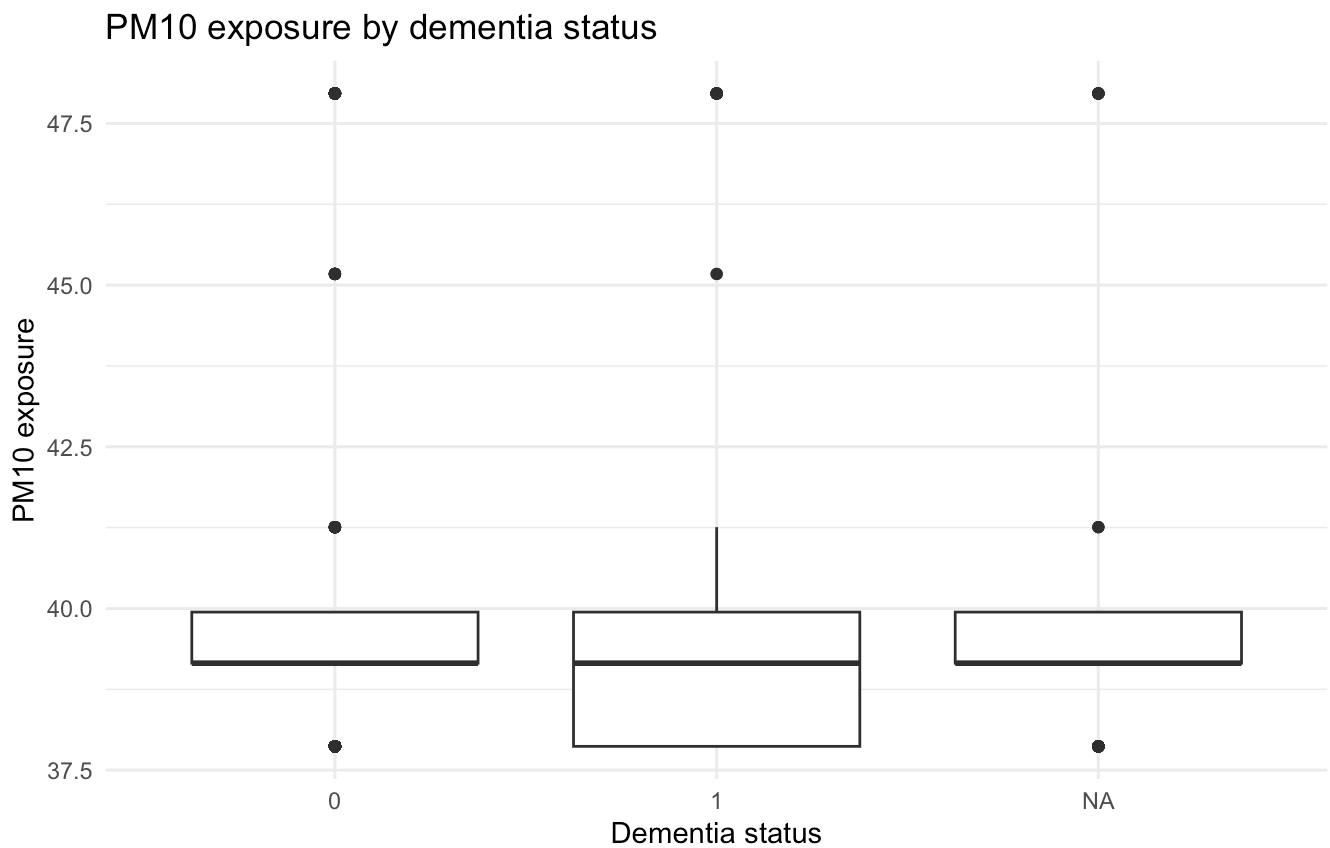
1.4 Descriptive Exploration

```
## # A tibble: 3 × 6
##   dc_binary      n pm25_mean pm25_sd pm10_mean pm10_sd
##   <dbl> <int>    <dbl>  <dbl>    <dbl>  <dbl>
## 1      0  1584     33.6   1.85     39.7   2.30
## 2      1   279     33.6   1.78     39.6   2.22
## 3     NA   126     33.6   1.84     39.8   2.29
```

```
# boxplots # pm 2.5
```



2 pm 10



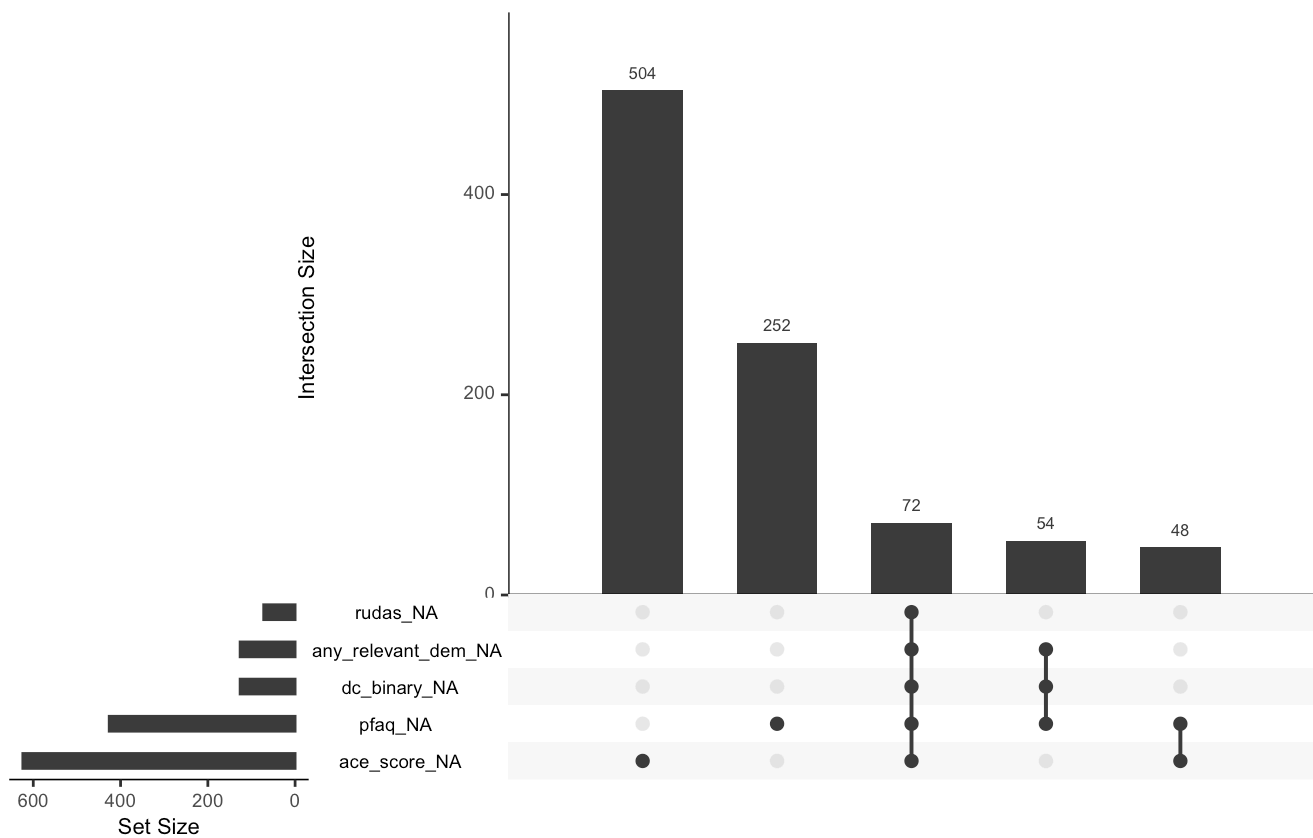
2.1 Analysis (Thursday, April 9)

1. dc_binary or any_relevant_dem as primary outcome
2. stratified analyses for older and younger adults with their continuous scores as secondary outcome

determine how many NAs there are for any_relevant dementia, dc_binary, rudas, ace, pfaq # how do they or do they not overlap?

```
## na_per_row
##      0      1      2      3      5
## 1059  756   48   54   72
```

```
## any_relevant_dem      dc_binary      rudas      ace_score
##           126           126           72           624
##           pfaq      geometry
##           426           0
```



Delete observations that are missing all five variables because they need at least one of those measures to be able to be in our analyses meaningfully.

```
## [1] 1917
```

```
##   n_rudas n_ace n_pfaq n_dc
## 1   1917  1365  1563 1863
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 4
##   took_rudas took_ace mean_age    n
##   <lgl>      <lgl>      <dbl> <int>
## 1 TRUE      FALSE      69.1   552
## 2 TRUE      TRUE       43.2  1365
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 5
##   took_ace min_age max_age mean_age    n
##   <lgl>      <dbl> <dbl>      <dbl> <int>
## 1 FALSE      60    95      69.1   552
## 2 TRUE       30    59      43.2  1365
```

2.2 Primary analysis: full sample

```
## dc_binary ~ exposure + age + sex
```


2.3 Secondary analysis: older adults (60+)

```
## as.numeric(rudas) ~ exposure + age + sex
```

2.4 Secondary analysis: younger adults (30-59):

```
## as.numeric(ace_score) ~ exposure + age + sex
```

2.5 Create the age groups:

2.6 Prep

2.7 Model 1

Full sample, binary outcome

2.8 Model 2

Older adults (60+), RUDAS

2.9 Model 3

Younger adults (30-59), ACE

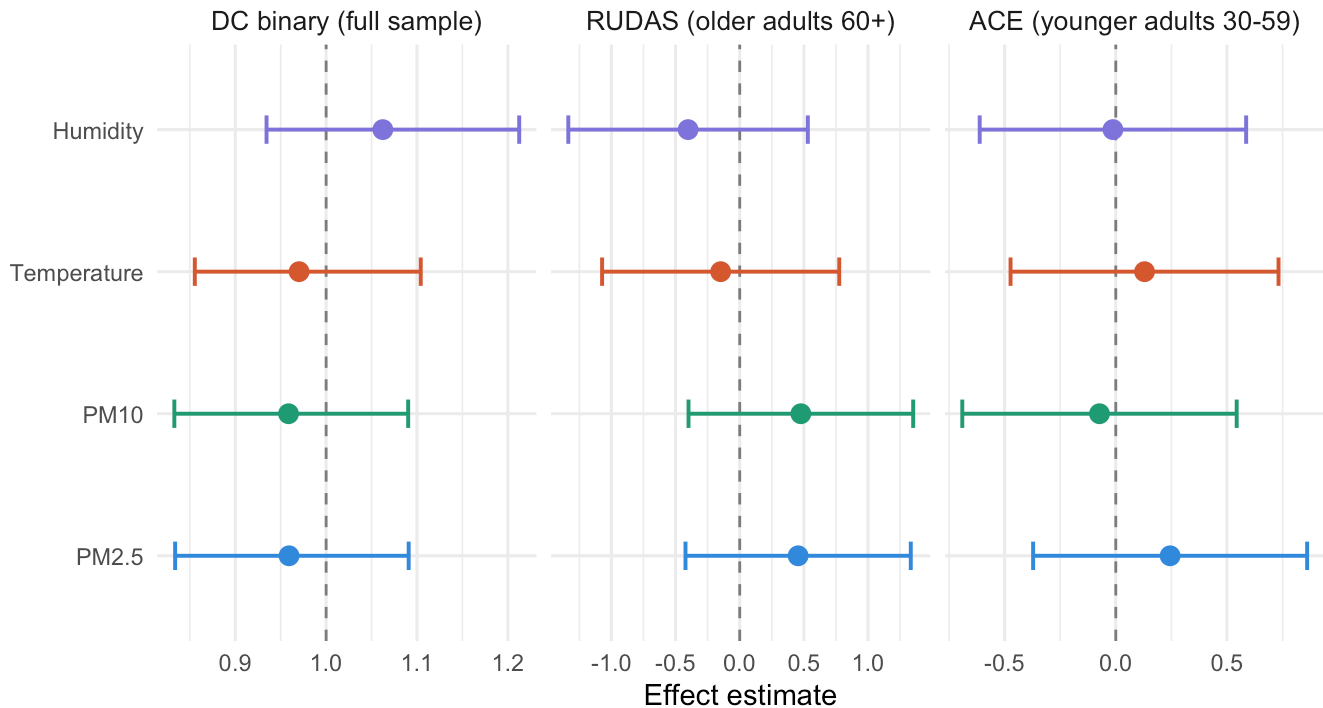
2.10 Combine

All results - binary results are ORs - linear results are beta coefficients - they are in separate facets so the scales don't mix

Association between environmental exposures and cognitive outcomes

Adjusted for age and sex. Exposures standardized (per 1 SD).

Binary outcome: OR; continuous outcomes: β coefficient.



```
## # A tibble: 4 × 5
##   exposure      estimate conf.low conf.high p.value
##   <chr>         <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 PM2.5         0.456   -0.423    1.33    0.309
## 2 PM10          0.477   -0.399    1.35    0.285
## 3 Temperature -0.148   -1.07     0.776    0.753
## 4 Humidity     -0.402   -1.34     0.531    0.397
```

2.11 Sensor zone comparison table to show descriptively whether zones with higher PM2.5 tend to have worse cognitive scores

No dose-response pattern for PM2.5 → cognitive decline. Looking at the four sensors with adequate sample size (ignore Ventanilla n=22 and Carab n=13 — too small): The highest PM2.5 zone (Comas) has the lowest % DC and highest RUDAS scores. This is an “ecological confounding” artifact made visible — Comas residents are younger, more educated, or otherwise healthier despite higher pollution. The sensor zones are not exchangeable populations.

This table is a valuable finding — it demonstrates why naive ecological exposure assignment produces misleading results, and motivates future work with better exposure characterization; a methodological lesson

```
## # A tibble: 6 × 6
##   nearest_sensor_name      pm25 pct_dc mean_rudas mean_ace      n
##   <chr>                <dbl> <dbl>      <dbl>    <dbl> <int>
## 1 GEOHealth_Ventanilla_NSBelen 30.9  14.3      3.45     77.9    22
## 2 GEOHealth_SanMa_IE005      32.6  16.6      6.80     78.1   456
## 3 GEOHealth_MiPeru_Chavinillo 32.7  15.1      6.85     77.6   587
## 4 GEOHealth_PuenteP_Estadio_1 34.0  14.1      7.84     79.0   725
## 5 GEOHealth_Carab_VictorRaulHT 39.6  15.4      5.38     78.4    13
## 6 GeoHealth_Comas_2055PAbril  40.1  13.5     10.4     78.0   114
```

2.12 Highways

The study area runs along what looks like a major highway corridor (the blue trunk road running north-south). Our participant points are clustered along and near this road. The red/pink dementia cases don't obviously cluster in one spot, but proximity to that trunk road varies meaningfully across participants — unlike the PM2.5 values which barely vary at all.

```
## Reading layer `highways_export' from data source
##   `/Users/gabriellebenoit/Documents/GitHub/peru_air/highways_export.gpkg'
##   using driver `GPKG'
## Simple feature collection with 345 features and 24 fields
## Geometry type: LINESTRING
## Dimension:      XY
## Bounding box:   xmin: 264542.2 ymin: 8681310 xmax: 277584.6 ymax: 8692089
## Projected CRS: WGS 84 / UTM zone 18S
```

```
## [1] "osm_id"      "name"        "alt_name"    "bridge"
## [5] "destination" "destination.ref" "foot"        "highway"
## [9] "junction"    "lane_markings" "lanes"       "layer"
## [13] "maxheight"   "maxspeed"     "motorroad"   "noname"
## [17] "note"        "old_name"     "oneway"      "placement"
## [21] "ref"         "source"       "surface"     "turn.lanes"
## [25] "geom"
```

```
## < table of extent 0 >
```

```
## [1] 345
```

```
##
##   primary secondary      trunk
##      22      240      83
```

```
##   Min. 1st Qu.  Median    Mean 3rd Qu.    Max.
##   9.293 331.501 754.896 1240.405 2053.607 4612.723
```

Meaningful continuous variation from 9 meters to 4.6 km. - Median 755m — half of the participants live within ~750m of a major road - Some very close (9m) — essentially on the road - Max 4.6km — good spread at the far end - Right-skewed (mean 1,240m >> median 755m) — confirms the need to log-transform

```
## # A tibble: 4 × 7
##   term          estimate std.error statistic  p.value  conf.low  conf.high
##   <chr>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 (Intercept)    0.239    0.439    -3.26  1.11e- 3    0.0999    0.560
## 2 log_dist_road  1.07     0.0523    1.29  1.95e- 1    0.967     1.19
## 3 age_n          0.990    0.00491   -2.04  4.11e- 2    0.980     1.00
## 4 sexMasculino   0.305    0.192    -6.19  6.17e-10    0.206     0.438
```

```
## # A tibble: 4 × 7
##   term          estimate std.error statistic  p.value  conf.low  conf.high
##   <chr>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 (Intercept)    8.71     5.50     1.58    0.114    -2.09    19.5
## 2 log_dist_road -0.112    0.368   -0.304    0.762   -0.835    0.611
## 3 age_n         -0.0101   0.0699   -0.144    0.885   -0.147    0.127
## 4 sexMasculino -0.00838  0.975   -0.00859  0.993   -1.92     1.91
```

```
## # A tibble: 4 × 7
##   term          estimate std.error statistic  p.value  conf.low  conf.high
##   <chr>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 (Intercept)   92.5     2.30    40.2  1.28e-233    88.0     97.0
## 2 log_dist_road -0.562    0.235   -2.40  1.67e- 2   -1.02    -0.102
## 3 age_n         -0.269    0.0358   -7.51  1.03e- 13   -0.339   -0.199
## 4 sexMasculino   4.69     0.720    6.51  1.02e- 10    3.28     6.10
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 × 5
##   near_road_500m pct_dc mean_rudas mean_ace    n
##   <lgl>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl> <int>
## 1 FALSE         16.2     7.13    77.8  1250
## 2 TRUE          12.7     7.84    79.2   667
```

This is the most interesting result yet. Participants within 500m of a major road have lower rates of cognitive decline (12.7% vs 16.2%) and higher cognitive scores (RUDAS 7.84 vs 7.13, ACE 79.2 vs 77.8) — the opposite of what you'd expect if road proximity is harmful. This is the same ecological confounding pattern observed with PM2.5 — the Comas sensor (highest PM2.5) also had the best cognitive scores. It's telling a consistent story: participants living closer to major roads in this study area are systematically different in ways that protect cognition — likely younger, more educated, better access to healthcare, higher SES. Urban proximity in a peri-urban Lima context may mean better services, not worse health.

2.13 Regression Models adjusted for age and sex

```
## # A tibble: 1 × 5
##   term          estimate  conf.low  conf.high  p.value
##   <chr>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 log_dist_road  1.07     0.967     1.19    0.195
```

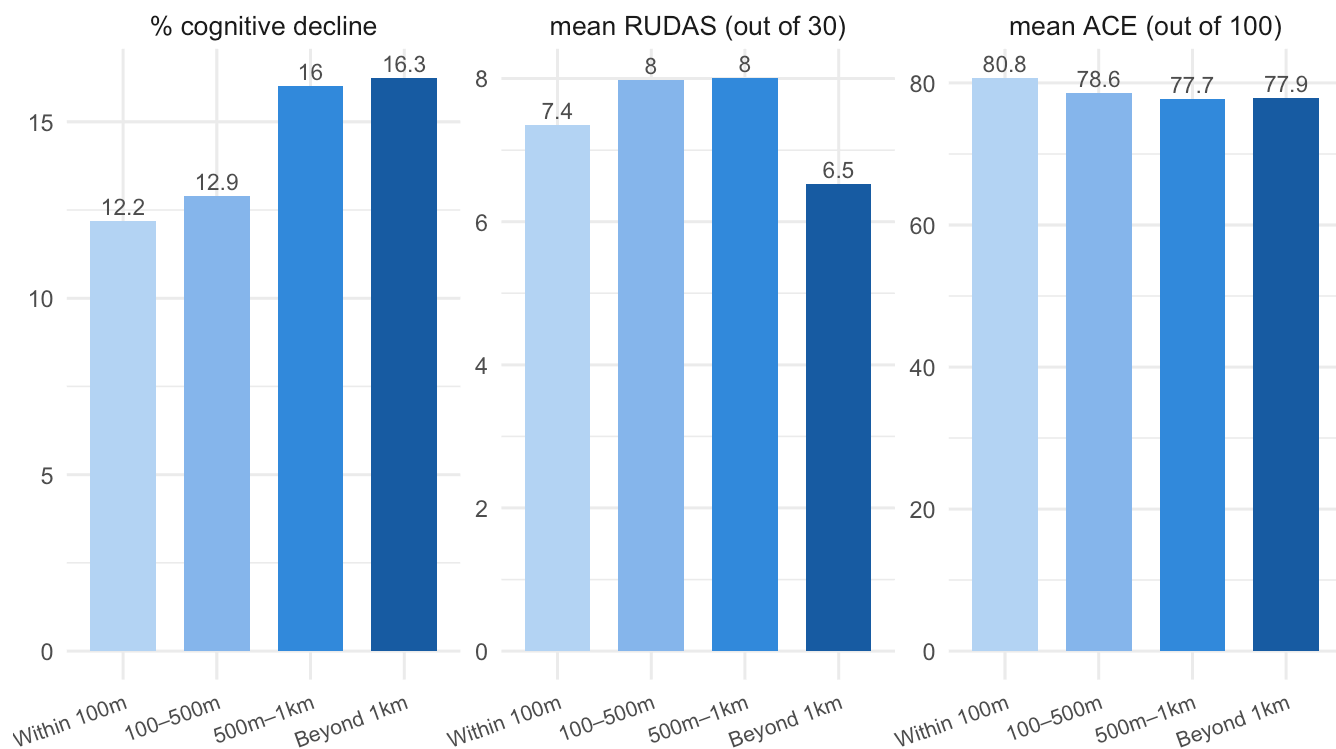
```
## # A tibble: 1 × 5
##   term          estimate conf.low conf.high p.value
##   <chr>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 log_dist_road  -0.112  -0.835    0.611    0.762
```

```
## # A tibble: 1 × 5
##   term          estimate conf.low conf.high p.value
##   <chr>          <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>
## 1 log_dist_road  -0.562  -1.02   -0.102    0.0167
```

2.14 Figure

```
## # A tibble: 4 × 5
##   buffer_zone pct_dc mean_rudas mean_ace    n
##   <fct>      <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl> <int>
## 1 Within 100m  12.2      7.35     80.8   159
## 2 100–500m    12.9      7.99     78.6   508
## 3 500m–1km    16.0      8.01     77.7   506
## 4 Beyond 1km   16.3      6.53     77.9   744
```

Cognitive outcomes by distance to nearest major road



Distance to nearest trunk, primary, or secondary road (OpenStreetMap). Unadjusted means.

The only significant finding is ACE in younger adults. Binary and RUDAS are null. This is a coherent and interpretable pattern

Only younger adults? possibly because ACE is a more sensitive, higher-ceiling instrument than RUDAS. Younger adults (mean age 43) have more cognitive reserve and more variance in scores to detect — so subtle environmental effects show up there first. Older adults' RUDAS scores may already reflect age-related decline

that swamps any road proximity effect.

Implications of the ACE findings: Among 30–59 year olds, each unit increase in log-distance from a major road is associated with a 0.56 point decrease in ACE score. Given ACE is scored out of 100, that's modest but statistically present. The direction — farther from roads = worse cognition — points to urban access rather than pollution as the operative mechanism in this setting.

2.15 The *storyline* for the chapter:

1. PM2.5 sensor zones — null, insufficient spatial variability
2. Distance to road — significant for ACE in younger adults, counterintuitive direction
3. Interpretation — urbanization-health paradox in peri-urban Lima, road proximity as access proxy

Implication — future studies need personal, granular exposure monitors + SES adjustment to disentangle pollution from access